

Can you get shredded if you do not eat protein? 🤔

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Jul 15, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/99eI5AUY-R0> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Without sufficient protein, weight loss comes at the cost of muscle. Brandon Carter explains why 1g of protein per pound of bodyweight is the target for getting shredded, and reveals protein's calorie-burning thermic advantage.

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Weight Loss vs. Fat Loss [0:00](#)

- Low protein intake will still cause weight loss, but the composition of that loss is the problem
 - Weight lost can come from muscle, water weight, or fat — not just fat
 - Losing muscle is a poor outcome even if the scale goes down
- The goal of getting "shredded" specifically requires preserving muscle mass, not just shedding pounds

The 1 Gram Per Pound Rule [0:10](#)

- Recommendation: **1 gram of protein per pound of bodyweight per day** to get shredded
 - This intake level helps preserve muscle while in a deficit
- Common objection addressed: "What if someone weighs 300 lb — should they eat 300g of protein?"
 - Response 1: Less than 1% of the population weighs 300 lb, so it's a rare edge case
 - Response 2: 300g is only 50g more than Brandon himself eats per day, making it less extreme than it sounds

The Thermic Effect of Protein [0:22](#)

- Protein has a uniquely high **thermic effect of food (TEF)** — your body burns 30–40% of protein's calories just digesting it
 - This is higher than the thermic effect of carbohydrates or fat
 - Practical example: eat 1,000 calories of protein → your body only net-absorbs 700–800 of those calories

- Brandon's analogy: it's like a cash-back reward when you make a purchase — "free money"

Protein is a "cheat code" for fat loss: you get to eat it, feel full, preserve muscle, AND burn extra calories processing it — all at once.